Igor Szuniewicz

Sound Designer /
Audio Programmer

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ADDRESSED TO

FH JOANNEUM
Institute of Design
& Communication
Sound Design MA
Graz, Austria

REFERENCED PROJECTS

Shadow Frames
Horror, UE5 + Wwise, C++

Not Today, Darling!
Racing, MetaSounds

Amorak
Animation, creature design

Ray Animation
Graduation film score

Transientica: AudioLab
ML beatbox game

AudioQ
VST3/AU plugin, C++/JUCE

CURRENT ROLE

Technical
Sound Designer
XR Labs, Belgium
VR/AR spatial audio

Letter of Motivation

Sound Design MA // FH JOANNEUM & Kunstuniversität Graz

Dear Admissions Committee,

When I started studying Game Sound Integration at Howest DAE in Belgium, sound design frustrated me. I couldn't see the point. Once I started collaborating with game developers and 3D animators, I stopped treating sound as an assignment. They started listening to my work. Really listening. They sent suggestions, referenced specific sounds, pushed back on details. For the first time, someone cared about what I was building. Within weeks I was watching layering tutorials at 2 a.m., writing Reaper scripts to speed up my workflow, and spending entire afternoons combining hippo, lion, and elephant recordings to sculpt a single creature vocal. Three years later, I'm still at it.

I played classical piano for twelve years in Kołobrzeg, Poland. That background shows up more than I expected: I think about dynamics first, about when to pull back, about what a rest does to everything after it. My high school was STEM-focused, so I ended up caring equally about how audio feels and how it works under the hood. At DAE, both sides got tested. On *Shadow Frames* I was lead sound designer for a horror game, building everything players hear, from the floor under their feet to the thing following them down the corridor. On *Not Today, Darling!* I was the sole sound designer on a racing game team. For *Amorak* I layered animal recordings until the creature vocal sounded like something that shouldn't exist, then mixed it all in binaural 3D.

Most of my time goes to the technical side. C++ systems, middleware, memory optimization. I'm good at it, but it's not the part that keeps me up past midnight. That happens when I'm layering, when a sound goes somewhere I didn't plan for it to go. In game production, the question is usually whether audio triggers correctly, not what it means. I want to work where the question is reversed. Modules like Sound Design for Film, Product Sound Design, and Sonification focus on exactly that. What a sound communicates, not just whether it fires.

The cooperation with KUG and IEM is what made me look at Graz in the first place. Our lecturers at DAE recommended the IEM plugin suite, and I used their StereoEncoder and EnergyVisualizer to mix a student animation called *Akantilado* in both 5.1 and Ambisonics. Learning from the people who actually built those tools, in a facility like the CUBE, is hard to pass up. I currently work as Technical Sound Designer at XR Labs in Belgium, designing spatial audio for VR/AR training simulations, so this is the direction I'm already moving in. The interdisciplinary project format matters too. When RITCS screenwriters shaped the narrative of *Shadow Frames*, it made my audio design sharper. When the original composer for the *Ray* graduation animation dropped out, I wrote and delivered the full score in eight days. It landed. I do my strongest work when other disciplines are in the room, and contributing to installations like Klanglicht is the kind of work I want to grow into.

I have three years of game audio, spatial audio from VR production, and a thesis on generative AI for real-time adaptive game audio. In a group, I'm the person who can design the sound and build the system that plays it. But the work I keep coming back to is the kind where listening is the point. Film, installations, spaces where the audience cannot look away from what they hear. Graz is where I want to take that further.

Kind regards,
Igor Szuniewicz



Kortrijk, 16.03.2026